

CURRENT STATUS OF MANGROVE REHABILITATION PROJECTS IN CEBU, PHILIPPINES By Filipina B. Sotto, Julie E. Albano and Thomas Hecger: Marine Biology Section, Department of Biology, University of San Carlos, Cebu City 6000, Philippines:—The current status of mangrove rehabilitation projects in Cebu Province implemented by DENR-ERDS 7, DA, CVRP-1 was assessed. Of the 49 municipalities and 5 component cities, 38 are undertaking mangrove rehabilitation of which 22 are implemented by DENR-ERDS 7, 3 by DA, 4 by CVRP-1 and 2 by NGOs. Fourteen sites were visited for validation and assessed in terms of the species used in rehabilitation, and species composition. Project valuation was also taken into consideration. Results showed that most of the rehabilitation established by the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR) was concentrated in the southern part of Cebu Province with a total reforested area of 430.25 ha, according to the records of CENRO, Cebu City. Only two species were used in rehabilitation, namely, *Rhizophora mucronata* and *R. apiculata*, and the survival rate was 80%. Plantings started in 1989 for all these sites. The total project costs amounted to PHP 4,100,645.80, with funding sources from the OECF and ADB. The Central Visayas Regional Project (CVRP-1), was started on 1 July 1984, and the total rehabilitated area was 46.6 ha in Malhiao, Zaragosa Island, Badian and Palanas in Ronda. The CVRP-1 mangrove reforestation project was relatively more successful compared with the others, and the survival rate was 80%, even though the requirement for turn-over is only 40%. Eight species were used in the rehabilitation, and the project was funded by the World Bank. The Department of Agriculture's (DA) reforestation project was in Sitio Tacup and Kawanahan in San Remigio. The total area covered was 20 ha. Areas with 80% survival were turned over to recipients, while areas damaged by natural calamities were re—extended and abandoned areas were cancelled. In terms of funding, the propagules were provided free—of—charge by the DA. Problems encountered by the recipients were: non—cooperation from some stakeholders, low survival rates due to droughts and floods, and the availability of propagules. On the other hand, the problems encountered by the three government agencies were land ownership and non—approved FLAs, and the fact that the sites rehabilitated were under Proclamation 2151. All these hindered the turnover of the reforested sites to recipients.